

BALLINASCREEN & DESERTMARTIN PARISHES

30_AUGUST_2026

No. 44 ~ TWENTY-SECOND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

PARISH CONTACT DETAILS

Fr. Peter Madden PP VF

31 Sixtowns Road

Telephone: 79628376

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Fr Michael McCaul CC

50 Tobermore Road, Desertmartin

Telephone: 79632196

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

PARISH OFFICES

Ballinascreen:

9 High Street

Phone: (028)79628248

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Opening Hours: Monday, Tuesday and Thursday: 8.45 am - 3.30 pm. Wednesday: 8.45 am - 3.00 pm.

Desertmartin:

St Patrick's Keenaught

Phone: (028)79397047

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

Opening Hours: Wednesday and Thursday 10.30 am to 3.00 pm.

SAFEGUARDING

Safeguarding Contact Information

If you have any concerns with regard to the safeguarding of children within the Church, please contact:

Marie O'Kane - Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) Tel.: +44 7596 500793 or Email: dlp@derrydiocese.org

Northern Ireland Emergency Services

- PSNI (Police Service of Northern Ireland): 101
- Social Services:
 - Gateway Services, Western HSC Trust: 028 7131 4090 (ask for the Duty Social Worker)
 - Gateway Services, Northern HSC Trust: 028 9442 4459
 - Regional Emergency Social Work Services: 0800 1979 995

LIFELINE

Tel: 0808 808 8000 / Textphone 18001 0808 808 8000.

www.lifelinehelpline.info

SVP HELPLINE

Helpline telephone number: 07710838050

GAMBLING HELPLINE

Help is available, phone: 02871351329

SPERRIN FOODBANK

Tel: 07543420639

BALLINASCREEN COMMUNITY SUPPORT GROUP

Please click the link <https://www.parishofballinascreen.com/ballinascreen-community-support-gro> for full details of Ballinascreen Community Support Group.

A rectangular wooden sign with a light brown background and a thin wooden frame. The words "Bulletin Notes" are written in a black, cursive-style font in the center of the sign.

Bulletin Notes

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices for the Bulletin should be received by 1.00 pm on Wednesday, preferably by email.

Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Email: desertmartinparish@gmail.com

VIGIL MASSES FOR SUNDAY

Holy Rosary: 6.00 pm

St Patrick's, Keenaught: 7.30 pm

SUNDAY MASSES

St Columba's, Straw: 9.00 am

St Mary's, Coolcalm: 10.00 am

St Patrick's, Sixtowns: 11.00 am

St Eugene's, Moneyneena: 12 noon

MASSES FOR THIS WEEK

Monday ~ 31 August

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Tuesday ~ 1 September

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm. DDS Mass.

Wednesday ~ 2 September

10.00 am ~ Holy Rosary Church.

Thursday ~ 3 September

10.00 am ~ St Mary's, Coolcalm

Friday ~ 4 September

10.00 am ~ St. Mary's, Coolcalm.

7.30 pm ~ Holy Rosary.

CONFESSIONS

Ballinascreen: Holy Rosary 5.30 pm - before Vigil Mass.

Desertmartin: Keenaught, Saturday 6.30 pm until 7.10 pm.

FEASTS OF THE WEEK

Monday 31 August: St Aidan of Lindisfarne.

Tuesday 1 September: World Day of Prayer for the Care of Creation.

Thursday 3 September: St Gregory the Great.

Friday 4 September: St Mac Nissi.

Saturday 5 September: St Teresa of Calcutta.

SEASON OF CREATION 2026

The Season of Creation takes place from 1 September to 4 October, bringing Christians throughout the world together in prayer, reflection and action for the care of our common home. This year's theme, *Living Water*, invites us to give thanks for the gift of water and renew our care for God's creation.

DERRY DIOCESAN SOCIETY

The following Masses will be offered for the members of the Derry Diocesan Society: Sunday 6 September at 10.00 am in St Mary's, Coolcalm, & Wednesday 9 September at 10.00 am in The Holy Rosary.

DEATHS

We extend our prayerful sympathy to the family and relatives of:

Manus McShane, Bellaghy;
William McKenna.

MONTHS MIND MASS

The Months Mind Mass for Anne McKenna, Moykeeran Drive, will be held on Friday 4 September at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

FIRST ANNIVERSARY MASS

The First Anniversary for Eugene Kelly, Magherafelt, will take place on Friday 4 September at 7.30 pm in Holy Rosary Church.

ANNIVERSARIES

Ballinascreen:

Rose Celine Cleary, Sixtowns Rd.;
Hugh Donnelly, Tobermore Rd.;
Frankie McCloskey, Mulnavoo Rd.;
Mary Crossett, Ranaghan Rd;
Daniel Mullan, Campbelltown Terrace;
Henry Devlin, Slievegallion Park;
Annette McWilliams, Dunmurray.

Desertmartin:

Mary Woulhan;
Thomas McPeake;
Mary McPeake;
Francis Murray;
Danny MacOscar;
Annie McGlinchey.

BAPTISMS

We welcome into God's family through the Sacrament of Baptism:

Jude Donnelly, Sydney, NSW;
Maggie Mae Peyre, Farm Lodge Lane, Magherafelt;
Aodhan John McCullagh, Knocknagin Road, Desertmartin;
Theo Patrick Anthony McNally, Mulinderg, Moneyneena.

PARISH COLLECTIONS

Ballinascreen:

Weekly Collection - £1658
Renovation Collection - £2191.34

Desertmartin:

Weekly Collection - £1,313.90
Thank you for your generous support which is greatly appreciated.

DONATION

Fr Madden wishes to acknowledge £100 donation to Ballinascreen Parish Renovation Fund.

SUMMER BONANZA DRAW WINNERS ~ WEEK 3

£1000 ~ Owen & Jenny Kelly;
£200 ~ Benji, Ruaidrai & Eiréann;
£100 ~ Muireann O'Neill.

You may still purchase a ticket to be entered in the draw for the final week!

Week 5 (5 September): 1st Prize ~ £2000; 2nd Prize ~ £500; 3rd Prize ~ £300.

THE PADRE PIO PRAYER GROUP

Meeting in Holy Family Chapel, Ballymagroarty on **Tuesday 1 September 2026**. Starting with Rosary at 6.45 pm, before Mass. Holy Mass at 7.15 pm, then the priest will bless everyone with a first-class relic of St. Pio, while closing prayers are recited. *Everyone Welcome*.

ENCOUNTER SCHOOL OF MINISTRY COURSE

Unsure what it's about or if it's for you? We invite you to 'Come & see' what it's about before you make your decision. Class will take place on Thursdays from 6.30 pm (first half hour is prayer and worship) to 9.00 pm beginning on **3rd September** at All Saints Church, Newtowncunningham, Co. Donegal (10 mins from Derry). Participants can attend up to 3 classes without committing to pay for the course. If a

participant decides to enrol before the application deadline of October 1st, tuition fees will then be applied. If a participant decides not to continue, there is no obligation. More info or register here: <https://encounterschool.org/donegal/> or Email: donegal@encounterschool.org for more information.

CORMAC Ó CEALLAIGH CCÉ MUSIC CLASSES.

Were you at the best Fleadh Cheoil ever in Belfast? Were you wishing that you or your children were able to play or sing like all those musicians at the Fleadh? Maybe you played as a child and are now inspired to pick up your instrument again? There is an answer to all these questions!

Classes in fiddle, tin whistle, concertina, harp, banjo/mandolin, guitar, traditional singing and bodhran start at end of September.

There will also be an adult only mixed instrument class, for all lapsed players, who want to start playing again.

Two new classes will also be offered: drumming (for beginners) and Seisiún tunes repertoire (for the more advanced musicians).

Please register early to avoid disappointment as classes are kept small. Preference will be given to current members.

Registration closes on 5 September to allow time to organise tutors. Further details and the Klubfunder link to register for classes are on Cormac Ó Ceallaigh CCÉ Facebook page.

SIXTOWNS CROSS CUMMUNITY CENTRE.

Tea/Coffee Morning to Start off our 25th Anniversary Celebrations of the Centre on Sunday 6 September at 11.30 am. Everyone Welcome

CATHOLIC MOTHERS IRELAND – FAMILY DAY

Annual National Mass on Sunday 6 September at Termonbacca Retreat Centre, Derry. Mass at 2.00 pm, celebrated by Bishop McKeown, followed by refreshments, children's activities, and a talk for parents.

This promises to be a lovely day for the whole family. For more details and to book please email info@catholicmothers.ie. All welcome.

FREE ONLINE STRESS CONTROL CLASSES

Next block of classes commence at 9.00 am on Monday 7 September at <https://ni.stresscontrol.org/>. Any questions or queries, please email stress.control@northerntrust.hscni.net

KNOCKNAGIN HALL

Irish Class: Resumes on **Monday 7th September**. Partly supported by MUDC. **Bunrang (Beginners) from 6:45 pm to 8.00 pm**. Suitable for people who have no Irish & wish to learn, or for those who have learned Irish previously and wish to renew or build upon their learning. **Meánrang (Improvers) from 8.00 pm to 9:30 pm**. Suitable for people who already have a basic grasp of Irish, who have completed a beginner class, or recently studied it in school, but want to build confidence and fluency. To book a place by knocknaginhc@gmail.com or phone 028 79631744. Cost 8 wks £40 payable on the first night.

Chair Exercises: Continues on Tuesday from 10.00 am to 11.00 am. Everyone welcome. Admission £4.

Irish Dancing Lessons: Continues on Tuesdays from 5:30 pm to 7.00 pm. To register, contact Nicola: 07518 207458

Bowling Club: Recommences on Tuesday 1 September from 8.00 pm, Suitable for all ages, from 9 to 90. Everyone welcome.

Line Dancing Classes: Continues on Wednesday from 7:30 pm, Suitable for all ages, from beginners to experts. Adm £5. Everyone welcome.

Acrobats Gymnastics Club: Recommences on Saturday 5 September from 9.00 am to 2.00 pm

CHILD SAFEGUARDING INFORMATION TRAINING

Ballinascreen & Desertmartin Parishes on Wednesday 9 September 2026 in Desertmartin Parochial Hall from 7.00 pm to 8.00 pm. All priests and those volunteering within our parishes should attend.

DRAPERSTOWN PRESBYTERIAN CHURCH

An evening of Gospel Music and Praise on Friday 11 September at 7.30 pm. Suitable for all ages and tastes. Everyone welcome. All proceeds and donations to Mission Work.

BLESSING OF BIKERS AND MOTORCYCLES

Sunday 13 September in St Aengus' Chapel, Burt, at 1.30 pm. All welcome to attend the brief service and blessing, after which all are welcome to join the run to Ned's Point RNLI Station, to present the donation to the RNLI.

Please note, Mass will be celebrated on Sunday 13 September at 11.30 am in **St Patrick's Church, Dungiven**, for deceased bikers, especially those who have died in the past year.

BALLINASCREEN GAC

Irish Language and Culture Night at 7.00 pm on Friday 18 September. More details to follow on Ballinascreen GAC social media pages.

Ballinascreen GAC hope to enter teams in the Junior Scór Dhoire in October. Contact John on 07471374398 to register or for any queries.

ST PIO KNOCK PILGRIMAGE

National Knock Pilgrimage in honour of St Pio of Pietrelcina on Sunday September 20. Coach will leave from Holy Rosary Church at 7.00 am, pickup at St Mary's Coolcam (7.10 am) returning at 10.00 pm approx. Fare £35 (includes breakfast) payable on booking. All welcome.

To book please contact: 07836366949 or 07732125316 or 07769720546.

DONEGAL GROUP 173 RISE AND SHINE TRUST

Celebrating 40 years of taking young people with special needs to Lourdes each Easter. A special Mass will be held on Saturday 26 September in the Church of the Irish Martyr's Letterkenny at 12 noon. Concelebrated by Bishop Niall Coll and Bishop Donal Mc Keowan Diocese of Derry. We invite all the guests, their families and all the helpers who travelled with us over the years to celebrate Our Lady of Lourdes.

MICHAEL ENGLISH CONCERT ~ SPONSORSHIP

Any business or company who would like to be one of the sponsors for the Michael English Fundraising Concert should please contact Fr Madden: Tel.: 028 79628376 or Email either Parish [Office desertmartinparish@gmail.com](mailto:desertmartinparish@gmail.com) or ballinascreenparish@gmail.com. All sponsorship will be gratefully received and acknowledged.

MICHAEL ENGLISH & BAND LIVE CONCERT

Enjoy a rare and intimate evening with Michael English, one of Ireland's most popular entertainers. This exclusive acoustic performance of uplifting music filled with hope, faith and community spirit takes place on Friday 2 October, at 8.00 pm in St. Patrick's Church, Keenaught. All proceeds from this special fundraising concert will go to towards the Parish of Desertmartin, Church Renovation Fund. Tickets £30 each are now available to buy from Heron's Gift Shop, Moneyneena Post Office, both Parish Offices, or online (**Click Here**) with Eventbrite or use this QR code:



SIXTOWNS CROSS COMMUNITY GROUP

A special 25th Anniversary celebration event will be held on Friday 9 October at 8.00 pm in Sixtowns Hall. A great night of music & entertainment has been arranged with special guests Country Harmony, Patsy O'Hagan, Justin McGurk, Hugo Duncan and Brendan Quinn. Tickets are £20 and available from Heron's Gift Shop, Ballinascreen Credit Union, Straw Service Station & Committee Members.

ST JOSEPH MEN'S CAMINO

Every Camino changes us in ways we don't expect, every man needs one.

25km pilgrimage through the Boyne Valley, beginning in Drogheda on Saturday 12 September. The day includes Mass, Adoration, Rosary, Confessions, fraternity, lunch and dinner. Open to men aged 18+. Cost: €65 /student €55. Registration and more details please visit

www.dominicans.ie/events or email op.evangelisation@gmail.com

PARISH BAPTISMS 2026

Ballinascreen Parish:

All bookings to be made via Ballinascreen Parish Office on 02879628248 or Email: ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

Baptisms will be held at 3.00 pm on the following dates:

- 5 September, Sixtowns. (**Saturday**)
- 13 September, Straw.
- 4 October, Holy Rosary.
- 17 October, Sixtowns. (**Saturday**)
- 1 November, Straw.

Desertmartin Parish:

To book a baptism, contact Fr McCaul on 02879632196 or Desertmartin Parish Office on 02879397047. Baptisms can be held in either church and are held at 1.30 pm on the following dates:

- September 6 & 27 2026
- October 4 & 18 2026
- November 8 & 22 2026
- December 6 & 20 2026
- January 10 & 24 2027
- February 7 & 21 2027
- March 7 & 14 2027

NOTICES FOR THE BULLETIN

Notices should be received by **1.00 pm on Wednesday**, preferably emailed to ballinascreenparish@gmail.com

PARISH ANNIVERSARY MASS & MONTH'S MIND MASSES

If you wish to have a deceased loved one prayed for at any Anniversary Friday Mass, please email their name to the Parish Office by **1.00 pm on Wednesday** of the relevant week. Notices for First Anniversary and Month's Mind Masses should be received before **1.00 pm on Wednesday of the previous week** so that, they may be printed in the Bulletin the weekend before the Anniversary Mass.

PRAYER FOR VOCATIONS

That the men called to priesthood will be filled with courage and hope as they hear Jesus calling them to follow Him by renouncing themselves, taking up their cross every day, and finding life in Him and in the service of His people.
